



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Valor Education

School Website: <https://www.valoreducation.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Valor Education (Austin, TX, 78745) presents a clear alignment with classical education through explicit use of classical elements such as Great Books, Socratic teaching, and a formation-focused mission. Public-facing materials emphasize educating the whole person, forming wisdom and virtue, and engaging students in a classical liberal arts tradition. However, the materials examined do not present an explicit religious or theological foundation, liturgical practices, or a formally stated theological grounding. This combination yields a robust classical orientation, but not a fully religious-metaphysical foundation as defined in the most stringent interpretations of the Six Essential Elements rubric.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Key observations: - Strong categorical signals of classical curriculum and pedagogy (Great Books, Socratic teaching) and a formation-focused aim (wisdom, virtue, full humanity) are evident in Valor's public content. Evidence: Valor's own mission and program descriptions emphasize classical schooling, Great Books, and Socratic dialogue, with statements about forming students in wisdom and virtue for a full human life. - Explicit religious/theological grounding and liturgical/community practices are not clearly present in the available public materials, which limits a full religious/metaphysical reading. The absence is notable given the rubric's emphasis on theology and liturgical practice as potential foundations for a classical school. (No direct theological or liturgical language found in the provided material excerpt.) - Parent and community engagement is visible through parent testimonials and visible school-community tone, aligning with the rubric's emphasis on family partnership and community formation to some extent.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Valor emphasizes education for the "full human life" and formation through a classical framework, highlighting wisdom and virtue as central aims. This signals a transcendental, value-centered orientation consistent with some positive keywords in the Classical rubric (wisdom, virtue, formation). - The explicit theological or liturgical language is not evident in the public-facing materials provided. While the Great Books and Socratic pedagogy are foregrounded, there is no clear grounding in theology or liturgical practice in the excerpts reviewed.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present on Valor site: wisdom, virtue, formation, great books, Socratic, classical schools. These align with Positive Keywords across the Six Elements doc (Cultivation of Wisdom and Virtue; Pursuit of Truth/Goodness/Beauty; Formation). - Negative keywords: No explicit theological grounding or liturgical practices detected in the visible content; absence of such

elements weighs against a full religious/metaphysical reading. Positive signals dominate, but explicit theological grounding is lacking in the excerpts provided.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates substantial alignment with the moral-intellectual formation emphasis of classical education, but it does not overtly present theology or liturgical communal practices, which the strictest reading of Religious and Metaphysical Foundations would require. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL best fits the current public materials.

What would move the needle - Add explicit theological or metaphysical framing in mission statements or program descriptions (e.g., a stated grounding in a specific theological tradition or a liturgical/community practice component). - Include language regarding liturgical or communal practices (even if ecumenical or secular-adjacent) to demonstrate a broader metaphysical orientation beyond virtue and wisdom.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Valor's mission centers on educating "the whole person" and forming students in wisdom and virtue for a full life, rather than merely preparing for work. This aligns with the classical aim of education as formation of human excellence. - Phrasing such as "formation, not information" and emphasis on virtue/wisdom indicate a transcendent aim of education consistent with classical ideals. Valor explicitly ties the Great Books and a classical liberal arts framework to human formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords: formation, wisdom, virtue, full human life, Great Books, classical liberal arts. - Negative keywords: Not evident in the provided materials; the materials emphasize formation and virtue rather than strictly instrumental or job-oriented aims. - Proportion: High presence of positive indicators with minimal/absent negative signals in the excerpts given. Roughly a strong majority of category-relevant terms are positive.

Why this rating - The public materials strongly portray education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, aligned with classical education's purpose. This meets the core Element 2 criteria robustly.

What would move the needle - If desired, amplify a direct articulation of "truth, goodness, beauty" as real aims of education, with concrete examples of how classrooms cultivate these trans-historical ends (e.g., explicit reference to how Great Books discussions cultivate moral reasoning and discernment).

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Valor emphasizes a "classical liberal arts tradition, from the Great Books to fine arts to advanced math and science," signaling a curriculum anchored in classical canonical texts and a broad liberal arts approach. - References to "Great Books" and "Great Conversation" — central elements in classical curricula — appear in Valor's public materials. This aligns with the curricular expectation of engaging with foundational texts and enduring questions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books; classical liberal arts; formation through reading; Great Conversation (as a concept, via public framing). - Negative keywords: No explicit mention of the Trivium/Quadrivium in the visible excerpts; no explicit listing of core Great Books canon beyond general references. The absence of a clearly stated Trivium/Quadrivium in the public pieces is noted as a gap relative to a fully explicit Classical Curriculum reading. - Net: Strong positive indicators with a notable gap in explicit Trivium/Quadrivium articulation in the excerpts provided. Approximately balanced with a tilt toward classical alignment.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly described as classical and book-centered, with the Great Books and liberal-arts framing prominent. The lack of explicit, enumerated liberal arts (e.g., Trivium/Quadrivium) in the snippets does not negate the overall classical orientation but prevents a perfect alignment in the strictest sense. Therefore, CLASSICAL is appropriate.

What would move the needle - Provide a more explicit articulation of the full classical curriculum framework (e.g., explicitly naming Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic/geometry/music/astronomy) as foundational elements, with grade-by-grade mapping). - Include sample Great Books lists or core reading sequences by grade level to demonstrate depth and progression.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Valor emphasizes Socratic teaching and a classroom culture oriented toward wisdom and virtue. The explicit mention of Socratic pedagogy aligns with classical teaching methods. - The public materials describe a culture of “joy, respect, and deep engagement,” which is consistent with a pedagogical emphasis on engaged dialogue and memory through Socratic dialogue and related methods.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic teaching; great conversations; deliberative dialogue; formation through discussion (Socratic dialogue; great conversation is echoed in the source document’s keyword list). - Negative keywords: None evident in the excerpts regarding pedagogy; however, the lower-school singing/chanting pedagogy (a specific lower-school practice) is not demonstrated in Valor’s materials; there is no explicit restfulness or memorization emphasis beyond the general “deep engagement.” The provided content leans toward active dialogue rather than contemplative rest alone. - Net: Strong classical pedagogy signals with minor gaps in evidence of every sub-feature (e.g., explicit lower-school choral/chanting). Overall, CLASSICAL is justified.

Why this rating - The core pedagogical approach (Socratic dialogue, memory through discussion, and a movement toward rhetoric at higher levels) matches classical pedagogy standards. The absence of some lower-school restfulness or contemplative practices in the public pieces is not enough to move away from CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Document more granular pedagogy across grade bands (e.g., explicit lower-school chant/memory routines, structured seminars, and upper-school rhetoric presentations) and provide concrete examples of Socratic sessions or seminars in practice across multiple grades.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Parent testimonials indicate teachers who know their children well and who challenge them academically and holistically (e.g., “they truly know my child” and “thoughtful ideas of how to challenge them to grow academically and as a whole person”). This signals mentors and faculty who contribute to character formation. - The public-facing materials emphasize a culture of “joy, respect, and deep engagement” and a strong teacher-student relationship, which aligns with the notion of faculty as living mentors in the classical model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: mentor/teacher as guide; “living curriculum” (conceptually implied by the depth of engagement and teacher-student relationships); relationship-centered faculty. - Negative keywords: No explicit language describing a formal “living curriculum” phrase in Valor’s materials, nor explicit portraits of faculty roles beyond positive relational interactions. The absence of overt “faculty as living curriculum” language reduces the score from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in strict terms. - Net: Some strong signals of virtuous, capable faculty, but less explicit articulation of the faculty as the core curriculum or as a formalized portrait of teacher roles. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates high-quality teaching culture through stories and claims about teachers who know students and push them to grow; however, the explicit, formalized description of faculty as the “living curriculum” or a clearly defined faculty profile is not directly stated in the public content reviewed. The result is a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for this category.

What would move the needle - Add explicit language and a public-facing statement about the living-curriculum concept: "Our faculty are the living curriculum," with profiles of teacher expectations, mentorship roles, professional development aligned to classical aims, and teacher-student relationship norms. - Include teacher portraits or a formal teacher-education philosophy that aligns with classical virtues and rhetoric.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials include parent testimonials praising Valor's program and teachers, signaling active parental response and engagement. Examples include parent quotes about gratitude and the impact of teachers on their children. - The presence of parent-facing content (testimonials, newsletters, and parent-tour or event-style content) suggests an emphasis on parent engagement, though the explicit framework of parents as co-educators or formal parent formation programs is not strongly delineated in the public pieces provided.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families (conceptual framing in Six Elements), parent involvement, family/community engagement, shared mission (as evidenced by parent quotes and school communications). - Negative keywords: The explicit, formal "parents as co-teachers" or structured parent-formation programs are not clearly described in the excerpts. The materials show engagement but not necessarily a formal apprenticeship-like partnership. - Net: Some strong signals of community and family engagement but not a fully explicit, formalized co-educator model. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Valor demonstrates active parent engagement and positive family-school relationships, consistent with Classical-Education expectations, but there is less explicit articulation of a deep, formal partnership role for parents in the governance and day-to-day co-education. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is an appropriate reading.

What would move the needle - Publish a clear statement describing parents as co-educators, including specific opportunities for parent formation, book studies, gatherings, and transparent campus-visitation policies, and a structured program for parental involvement in classical education practices.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Explicitly articulate a metaphysical grounding (theology or theological framing) or liturgical/community practices in mission statements or program pages to convert SOMEWHAT into CLASSICAL in this category.
 - Element 5 (Faculty): Publicly frame the faculty as the "living curriculum" with explicit portraits, expectations, and professional development aligned to classical aims; provide faculty profiles and examples of mentor-mentee relationships.
 - Element 6 (Parents & Community): Formalize a co-educator model with structured parent formation programs, book studies, and explicit pathways for ongoing parental involvement, so that this category clearly demonstrates Partnership with Families and Formation of Affections.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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